

Zirui Zhao

Design & Marketing

Zirui Zhao
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Multidisciplinary artist, designer, student blending artistic intuition with cognitive science to create accessible, human-centered visual systems. Experienced across brand identity, editorial design, and advertising strategy through work with BCRC Montreal, Brave Hearts Alliance, and freelance clients. Proven track record of leading creative teams, managing large-scale campaigns, and delivering polished print and digital experiences. Specialize in Illustration and Graphic Design, proficient in Adobe Creative Suite with a sharp focus on typography, layout, and hierarchy.

Experience

BCRC Montreal / Marketing Communications Intern

June 2025 – August 2025

Led digital marketing and graphic design initiatives reaching 20K+ residents (700% engagement increase), designed multi-channel visual identities (160+ attendees), promoted social services to 200+ families.

Brave Hearts Alliance / Co-founder & Designer

July 2025 – Present

Developed scalable visual identity systems across print & digital channels (30,000+ reach); directed creative strategy for fundraising campaigns generating \$220,000+; orchestrated partnerships with 5+ organizations to deliver large-scale awareness campaigns.

McGill University / Research Assistant

April 2025 – Present

Engineered Python pipelines using lxml to parse 50,000+ keystroke data points from raw XML files; and co-authored quantitative research accepted to the 2026 CPA conference correlating computational metrics with bilingual language processing.

Freelance / Graphic Designer & Illustrator

November 2022 – Present

Directed a creative team of 16 in apparel production generating \$14,000+. Led visual strategy for publications reaching 300,000+.

Marianopolis College / Vice Chair of Communications

August 2025 – Present

Directed monthly ad campaigns via Adobe Creative Suite (30% engagement growth), orchestrated campus-wide brand messaging, and supervised 36 creatives across 100+ publications.

Education

Marianopolis College

August 2024 – May 2026

DEC, Pure & Applied Sciences
Dean's List, 2024-2026
Founder of Mariartists Art Club
Mental Health Mentor, IGNITE

College Jean-de-Brebeuf

DES, General Sciences
Basketball D4, D1
Founder of the Brebeuf Art Club

CalArts

Certificate of Extended Studies, Design

Awards

CPA 2026 - Poster Presentation
Odyssee de l'objet 2024 - Best Theme
MariHacks Hackathon 2025 - First Place

Skills

Brand Identity • Graphic Design • Editorial & Layout • Illustration • Animation • Print Production • Advertising Strategy • UI/UX Design • Wireframing & Prototyping • Web Design • Accessibility • Adobe CC • Figma • HTML/CSS • Python • Generative AI • Asana • Strategic Communication • Style Guides

Languages:

English (Fluent)
French (Fluent)
Chinese (Advanced)